

Sticky WICKET

Cricket's Mr Quick Fix, known for his networking skills and money-spinning strategies, faces allegations of sexual harassment and corruption



| By Amarnath K. Menon |

He is Mr Quick Fix to friends, mainly cricketers, as well as countless acquaintances. Others derisively describe him as the Dawood Ibrahim of cricket in Andhra Pradesh. The rest of India had known little about the swarthy, moustachioed V. Chamundeswaranath, 53, except that he had added another sorry and sordid chapter to India's miserable World T20 campaign.

As if India's on-field performance in England was not bad enough, Chamundeswaranath, their manager, found himself embroiled in a sordid scandal during the event. The man called 'Chamundi' may have

enjoyed phenomenal clout in the world of cricket, some of which led him to getting the job as World T20 manager, but was stripped of his office as the Andhra Cricket Association (ACA) secretary, following allegations of sexual harassment and financial misdemeanour. The ACA asked Chamundi for his explanation on the charges and divested him of his office with great speed. The nature of the allegations probably required it. Several female cricketers accused Chamundi of sending sleazy SMSes, demanding a hug when they offer to shake hands and stalking them at gyms.

One of the women is Andhra Pradesh women's team captain M. Savitha Kumari. "He made several

CHAMUNDI (CENTRE) WITH THE INDIAN TEAM AT THE ICC WORLD T20 CHAMPIONSHIP IN ENGLAND

attempts to lure girls and get close to them. I have opened up only to prevent innocent girls from being trapped," she says, alleging that she was offered a stint as a coach in England if she agreed to clam up. It was only after her complaints that the ACA took serious note of the charges.

Vishnu Raju, ACA vice-president, says, "He sent SMSes to the players at around 3 a.m. asking them to call back if they were alone and also asked them to hug him for any achievement. A simple thank you would not do for him." He says the complaints against Chamundi could